

Once you know your destination (lets say Jaipur), and you already know that you are starting from Delhi (Step 2) at an average speed of 70kmph (Step 1), then it becomes pretty simple to calculate the time taken to complete the journey. Let us get going with Step 3.

Step 3: Create a High Level Financial Freedom Plan

"Plan the work and work the plan" was our success mantra as project managers in the software industry. What it essentially means is that the first step is to plan the work before starting to execute the work. In our daily life, and similarly with financial planning, we are often tempted to get started fast and not "waste" our time on planning.

But it has been proven time and again that a good plan is half the battle won.

Have a clear plan, stick to it and strive hard to 'achieve' or 'over-achieve' the plan.

Such a plan will also make you think of innovative ways to meet your milestones in the plan. You can use any project planning tool to create your financial plan or, as I did it, you can use a simple Excel spreadsheet to plan your financial freedom and then use the same to track the actual progress as compared to the plan.

When it comes to planning, and that too if it is planning for your financial freedom, we need to make sure that the plan is Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic Timely (SMART). In the coming section you will see in detail how to develop such a plan.

High Level Financial Independence Plan

Planning starts at a high level and needs certain key inputs from the previous sections to proceed.